

Tragopan temminckii

Temminck's tragopan



Length 25 in (63 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

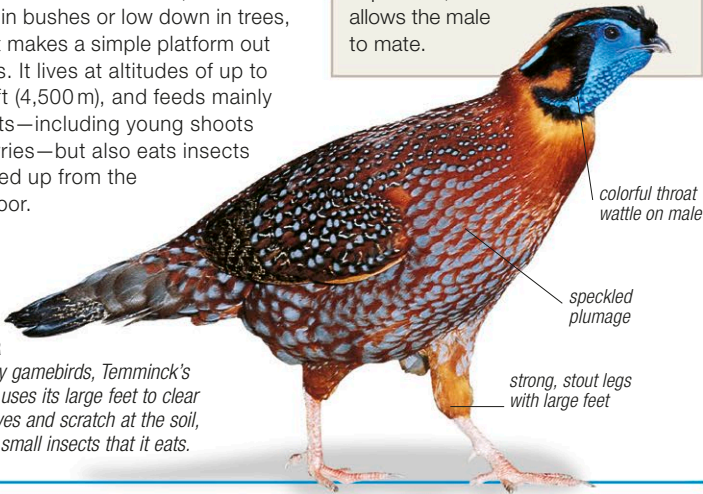
Location S.E. Asia



Male gamebirds often have flamboyant plumage, and this species is no exception. However, with Temminck's tragopan, the male's most conspicuous feature is a blue and red throat wattle, which looks like a multicolored bib. Like the other 5 species of tragopans (all from central and southern Asia), Temminck's is a forest bird, often nesting in bushes or low down in trees, where it makes a simple platform out of sticks. It lives at altitudes of up to 14,850 ft (4,500 m), and feeds mainly on plants—including young shoots and berries—but also eats insects scratched up from the forest floor.

FORAGER

Like many gamebirds, Temminck's tragopan uses its large feet to clear away leaves and scratch at the soil, exposing small insects that it eats.

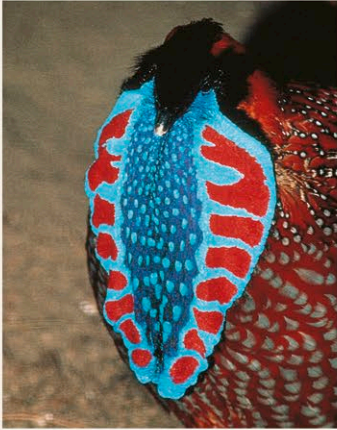


colorful throat wattle on male

speckled plumage

strong, stout legs with large feet

INFLATED DISPLAY



During his courtship display, the male inflates his colorful throat wattle until it covers his breast, and then shakes it to attract the female's attention. If the female is sufficiently impressed, she allows the male to mate.

Pavo cristatus

Indian peafowl



Length 6–7½ ft (1.8–2.3 m)
Weight 8¾–13 lb (4–6 kg)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location S. Asia



The male Indian peafowl, or the peacock, is one of the world's most spectacular gamebirds, with an iridescent blue body and a long train that is spread out like a fan when

courting females. The train is not the true tail, but consists of elongated tail coverts, each ending in a colorful "eye." The female—the peahen—is relatively drab, with a shorter train lacking the "eyes." The female chooses a mate on the basis of his appearance, and he usually turns to face her, shaking the train, erect and fanned, to reinforce its effect. He mates with many females, and gives a loud "kee-ow" call to advertise his presence. The male plays no part in building nests or raising the young. Like almost all gamebirds, the peafowl feeds on the ground, but roosts in tall trees at night, safe from most predators.



Gallus gallus

Red jungle fowl



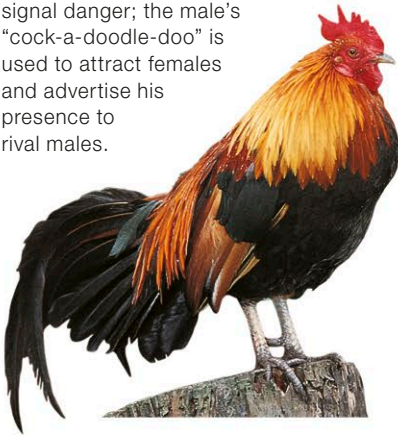
Length 32 in (80 cm)
Weight 1–3¼ lb (0.5–1.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location S. and S.E. Asia



This bird is the original ancestor of the domesticated chicken, first raised in captivity at least 5,000 years ago. The male is brightly colored, with fleshy red wattles and comb. The female is

smaller and drabber. Hens and chicks use calls to keep in contact and signal danger; the male's "cock-a-doodle-doo" is used to attract females and advertise his presence to rival males.



Argusianus argus

Great argus



Length 6¼ ft (1.9 m)
Weight Not recorded
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Near threatened

Location S.E. Asia



One of the world's largest pheasants, the male of this species has very large secondary flight feathers, decorated with egg-shaped "eyes," and a tail much longer than that of the female. To attract a mate, he calls loudly, raises his tail, and fans out his wings. The females with which he mates raise the young on their own.

Phasianus colchicus

Common pheasant

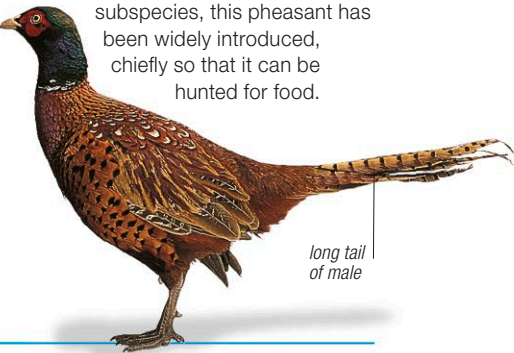


Length 35 in (89 cm)
Weight 1¾–4½ lb (0.75–2 kg)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location North America, Europe, Asia



Male common or ring-necked pheasants have a dark head with a purple and green gloss and red facial wattles; many also have a white neck ring and maroon breast. Compared to the drab brown female, the male is very colorful and larger, with a long tail. With 30 subspecies, this pheasant has been widely introduced, chiefly so that it can be hunted for food.



long tail of male

Numida meleagris

Helmeted guineafowl



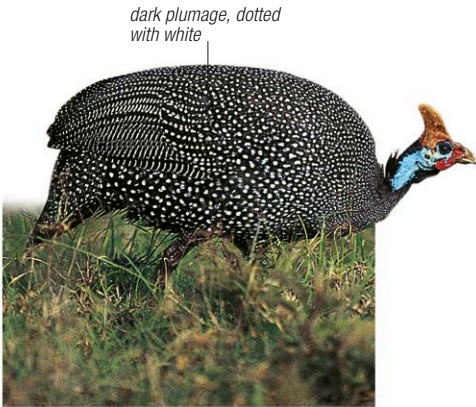
Length 22 in (55 cm)
Weight 2¼–3¼ lb (1–1.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location Africa (south of Sahara)



Domesticated long ago as a source of food, the helmeted guineafowl is a flock-forming gamebird whose natural habitat is the open grassland of tropical Africa. Its most conspicuous features are its spotted plumage and bony, hornlike helmet on top of its naked head. Males have a characteristic lateral, hump-backed posture during

encounters with other males and while courting. Compared to most gamebirds, it is well able to defend itself and its young—by pecking and scratching, and buffeting with its wings. A very noisy bird, when alarmed it gives a staccato "kek-kek-kekkek-kekkekkek" call.



dark plumage, dotted with white